

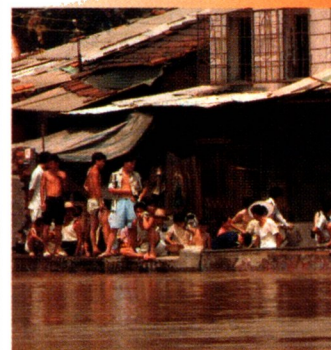
"WE NEED A CLIMATE OF INTELLECTUAL DISSIDENCE."



Amartya Sen

Professor Amartya Sen received the 1998 Nobel Prize for Economics on December 10. The first Asian to head an Oxbridge college, he was awarded for his analysis of famine and poverty. The backbone of his award-winning work stated that in many cases of famine, there was hardly any food shortage. The crisis occurred because of social and economic factors. He also helped develop Human Development Index that draws on observed features of living conditions.

- An earthquake measuring 6.1 in Afghanistan killed more than 5,000.
- The bombing of the US embassies in Dar es Salaam, Tanzania, Nairobi and Kenya killed 224 people and injured over 4,500.



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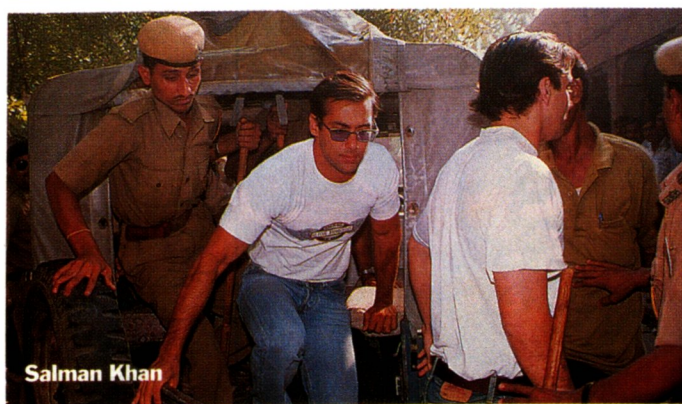
- The Yangtze River in China (above) broke through the main bank. The death toll exceeded 12,000.
- US President Bill Clinton admitted that he had an "improper physical relationship" with Monica Lewinsky. He also admitted he "misled people" about this affair.

CRIME AND PUNISHMENT

Bollywood's fascination with crime found a new and articulate troubadour in Ram Gopal Varma whose *Satya* captured a new street language and created a memorable villain in Bhiku Mhatre. But while Manoj Bajpai's wildness was restricted to the screen, Salman Khan flirted with danger in reality, apparently shooting a blackbuck while on the shoot of the squeaky clean Sooraj Barjatya's *Hum Saath Saath Hain*. Retribution from the Bishnois, the guardians of the wild, was swift. The actor had spent 71 hours in jail before being granted bail from a higher court. The trial continues in Jodhpur even today.



Satya



Salman Khan

8 per cent was what the Unit Trust of India (UTI) scam shaved off from the stock market in a single day. The scam permanently damaged UTI's reputation and the Government had to pour in Rs 3,300 crore to bail out the embroiled US 64 scheme.

P.V. Narasimha Rao after being denied a Lok Sabha ticket by the Congress

"My plight is like Draupadi's. Everyone watched her being disrobed. None came forward to help her."